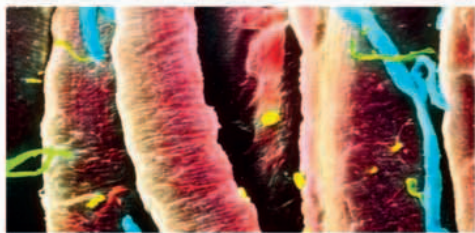


Muscle machine

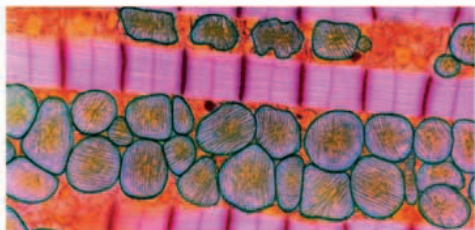
You can move because you have muscles—fleshy machines that turn fuel into motion by moving the bones of your skeleton. Some muscles are under your conscious control, such as when you decide to move your hand and turn the page of this book. However, there are many other muscles working away without you knowing to keep your body alive, healthy, and upright.

MUSCLE TYPES

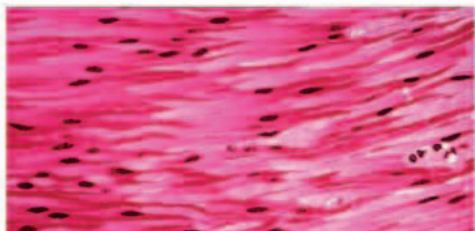
Your body has three types of muscle, seen here under a microscope. You use skeletal muscle to move your arms and legs, heart muscle to power your heart, and smooth muscle to move food along your digestive system.



▲ **SKELETAL MUSCLE** *Made up of bundles of threadlike fibers, skeletal muscle shrinks and shortens to pull tight and move bones.*



▲ **HEART MUSCLE** *This is a special type of muscle that never gets tired, because it has to keep your heart beating every day of your life.*



▲ **SMOOTH MUSCLE** *Made of long cells, often linked together in muscular sheets, smooth muscles form part of organs such as your stomach.*

AMAZING MUSCLES

The big muscles that cover your skeleton make up almost half your body weight. They form layers that work together to move all the parts of your body. About 640 of these skeletal muscles are under your conscious control. Some are very strong, like the ones at the tops of your legs, but others are built for precision rather than power.

